Social Media Marketing

Getting to know the social media platforms

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Lesson objectives

- Understand what a social media platform is
- Different categories of social media platforms
- Which social media channels are most popular by users
- Which social media channels are most popular for business social media marketing
- Facts and Demographics for top 10 channels used by businesses
- How to determine which channels to choose

Fun Fact

DID YOU KNOW: That there are thousands of social media platforms, but not all of them are being actively used.

Wikipedia has a running list of the active social media sites which currently stands at around 212! This a huge number of social media sites that you could potentially use.

If you go onto the wikipedia list you can also view social media platforms that target extremely niche markets that might be worth investigating.

Check it out! https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_social_networking_websites

What is a Social Media Platform?

According to Techopedia, a social platform is a web-based technology that enables the development, deployment and management of social media solutions and services. Types of Social Media Platforms

Community Platforms

Platforms where users can pose questions and receive answers, or start conversations with groups of people with similar interests. (Quora, Reddit)

Interactive Social Media

Platforms that are more interactive and use experimental features such as augmented and virtual reality, interactive games and music overlays. (Snapchat, TikTok)

Photo Sharing

Allows users to post images to visual feeds and interact with other users content. (Instagram, Pinterest)

Microblogging

Allows users to share short snippets of information that other users can interact with. (Twitter, Tumblr)

Social Networking

The most traditional form of social media - allows users to interact with each other in different ways. (Facebook, LinkedIn)

Video Sharing

Allows users to post videos to a feed that other users are able to watch and interact with. (YouTube, Facebook Live, IGTV, Vimeo)

Pros and Cons of Social Networking Platforms

Social Networking Pros

Facebook (B2C) and LinkedIn (B2B) are the most prominently used social networking platforms. Social networking sites mostly integrate with scheduling tools.

Capabilities of the platform extend to photo and video sharing as well.

Social Networking Cons

Posting only links without the use of images or video may not gain as much engagement. Platforms such as Facebook - as we discussed in lesson 1 - prioritise individual posts higher than business posts in news feeds.

Pros and Cons of Photo Sharing Platforms

Photo Sharing Pros

Help with brand awareness as images attract attention much more than text.

Provides an outlet for showing off highly visual content - such as for restaurants and product shots.

Photo Sharing Cons

Content upkeep may require a photo budget or dedicated production time.

Some platforms, like Instagram, are limited to mobile devices only.

Pros and Cons of Video Sharing Platforms

Video Sharing Pros

Rising video trends will keep your brand relevant

Helpful to a wide range of industries - how to videos, product explanation videos, demo videos, etc.

Video Sharing Cons

Content can be time-consuming to create and produce.

Video production can become costly.

Pros and Cons of Microblogging Platforms

Microblogging Pros

Microblogging allows you to share short, quick thoughts and ideas that attract attention.

Allows you to drive conversation and engagement.

Microblogging Cons

You are limited to the number of characters that you can post.

There is a huge chance of misinterpretation online, which means that you could start a social media shit storm around your brand. There is an old adage that says: all publicity is good publicity - the same is not true for social media.

Pros and Cons of Community Platforms

Community Pros

As a business you can answer users questions or comment on a discussion topic to place yourself as a thought leader within your industry.
Start your own community groups which can drive brand awareness as well an industry authority figure.

Community Cons

Getting downvoted may mean that your posts go unseen.
Your audience may be too niche or too small to build a community around.

Pros and Cons of Interactive Social Media Platforms

Interactive Social Media Pros

These platforms are creative and experimental - attracting young audiences.

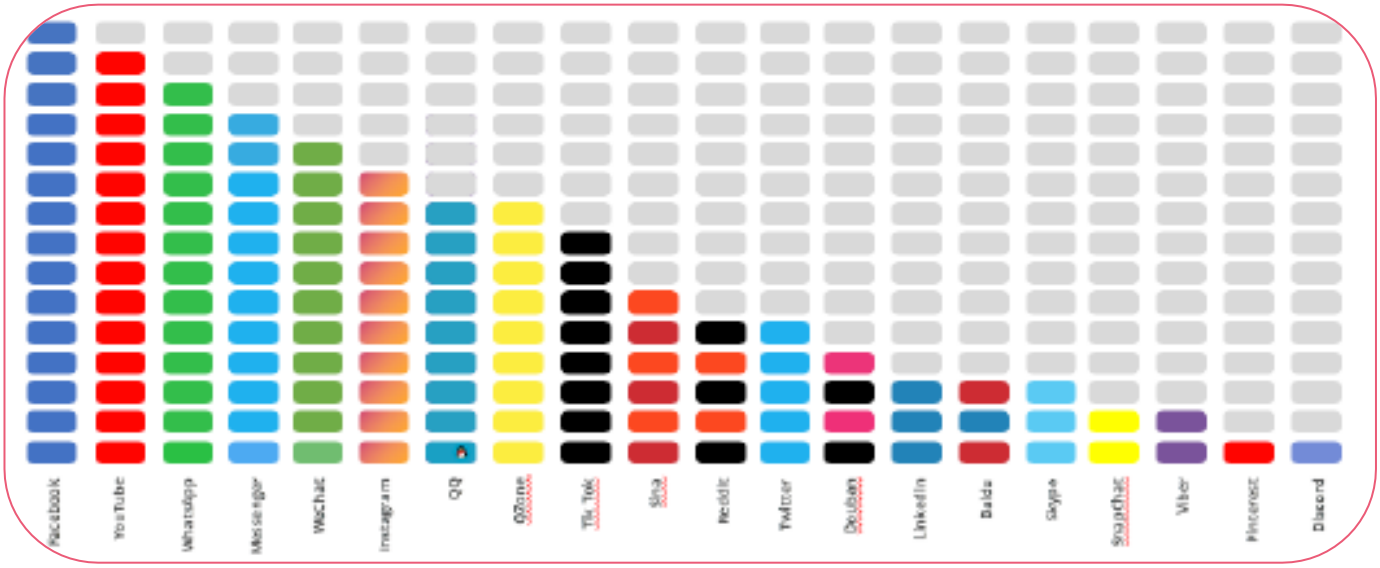
They are great for storytelling, which will attract people to your brand.

Interactive Social Media Cons

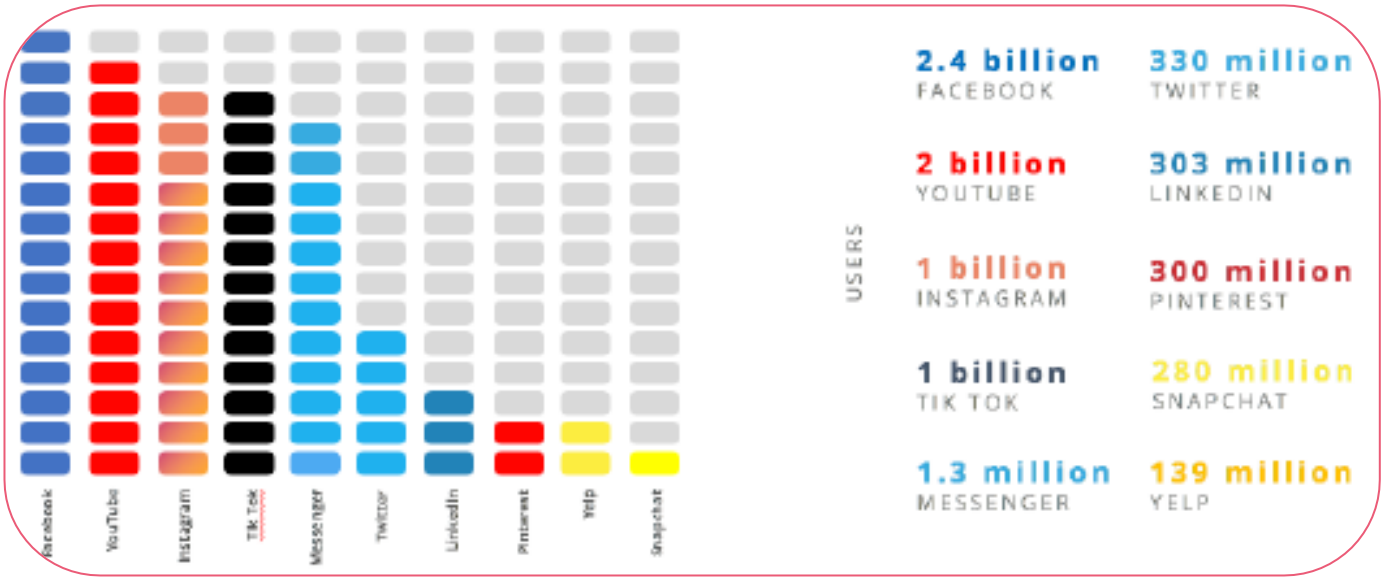
Regular content production can end up being time consuming and costly.

These platforms generally prioritise user content over business content.

Social Media Channels by Users



Social Media Channels by Businesses



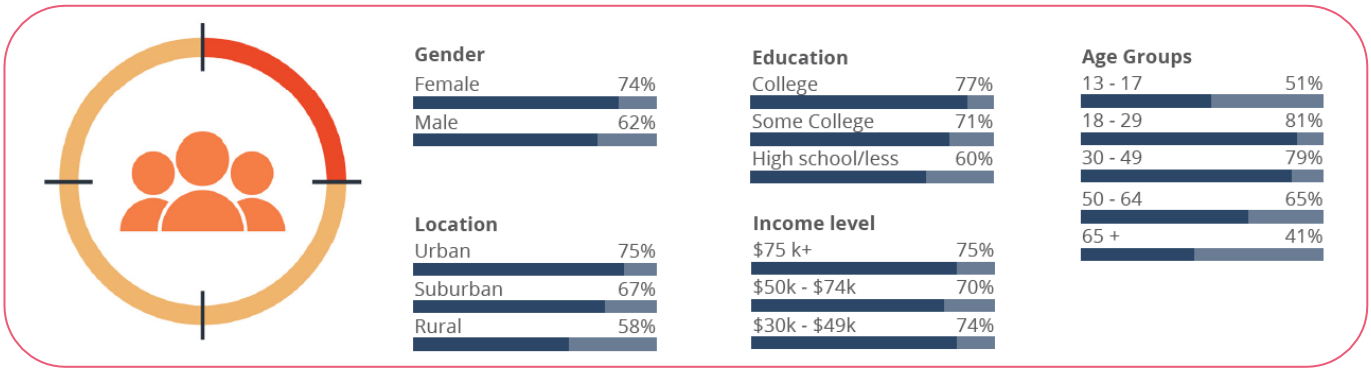
Social Media Channels by Businesses

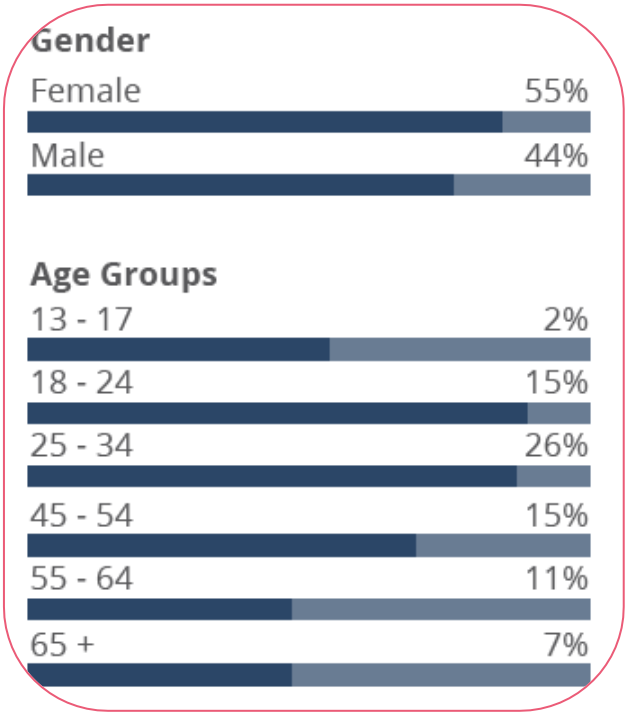
Facebook

Facts

- 56% of people visit Facebook to get information.
- The average price for an ad saw a 2% decrease while ad impressions grew by 34%.
- The potential reach of advertising for Facebook is 1.9 billion.
- 96% of Facebook users access the app on mobile
- Facebook's total number of desktop active users is 1.47 billion
- Images make up 18% of Facebook posts
- Link posts receive 76% less engagement than video posts
- Facebook Stories has 500 million daily viewers
- Politics is the highest category of Facebook Stories, at 36%
- 62% of people have reported being more interested in a product after seeing it on a Facebook video

Demographics





Messenger

Facts

- 40 billion businesses on Facebook Messenger
- 11% of the world's population use Facebook Messenger Monthly
- 300 000 chatbots on Facebook Messenger
- 200 countries use chatbots in Facebook Messenger
- 410 million people Facebook Messengers audio and video calling features every month
- 20 billion messages are sent monthly between users and businesses on Facebook Messenger
- The average group chat size on Facebook Messenger is 10 people
- The average number of emojis sent daily is over 5 billion
- An average of 25 000 GIFs are sent per minute on Facebook Messenger

Instagram

Facts

- Instagram has 1 billion monthly active users
- 500 million users make use of the platform every day
- Instagram is the second most engaged network after Facebook
- The average time spent on Instagram is 53 minutes
- 83% of instagrammers say they discover new products and services on Instagram
- 500 million Instagram accounts use stories every day
- 1/3rd of the stories that are viewed are from businesses
- 50% of Instagrammers follow at least one business
- Instagram generates over 4x more interactions than Facebook
- Instagram helps 80% of users decide whether to buy a product or service

Demographics

Gender

Female	39%
Male	30%

Location

Urban	42%
Suburban	34%
Rural	25%

Education

College	42%
Some College	36%
High school/less	29%

Income level

$75 k+	42%
$50k - $75k	32%
$30k - $49k	42%
$30k -	30%

Age Groups

13 - 17	72%
18 - 29	64%
30 - 49	40%
50 - 64	21%
65 +	10%

Pintrest

Facts

- 250 million people use Pinterest every month
- 80% of Pinterest users are on mobile
- 85% of women users use Pinterest to plan life moments
- 98% of Pinterest users try the ideas they find on Pinterest
- 59% of millennials have discovered products on Pinterest
- 90% of weekly users use Pinterest to make purchase decisions
- 55% of Pinners are looking specifically for products
- 78% of users say content from brands on Pinterest is useful
- Pinterest drives 33% more traffic than Facebook
- Pinterest users spend 29% more while shopping than non-users

Demographics

Gender

Female	41%
Male	16%

Location

Urban	29%
Suburban	31%
Rural	28%

Education

College	40%
Some College	32%
High school/less	18%

Income level

$75 k+	39%
$30k - $49k	34%
$50k - $74k	32%
$30k -	20%

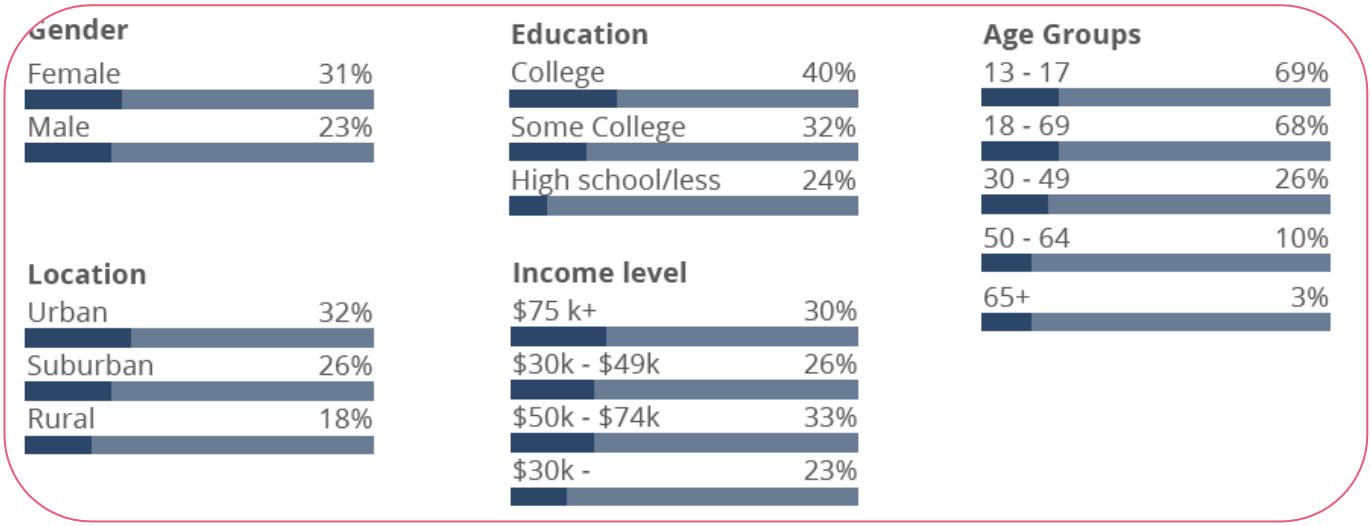
Age Groups

18 - 29	34%
30 - 49	34%
50 - 64	26%
65+	16%

Snapchat

Facts

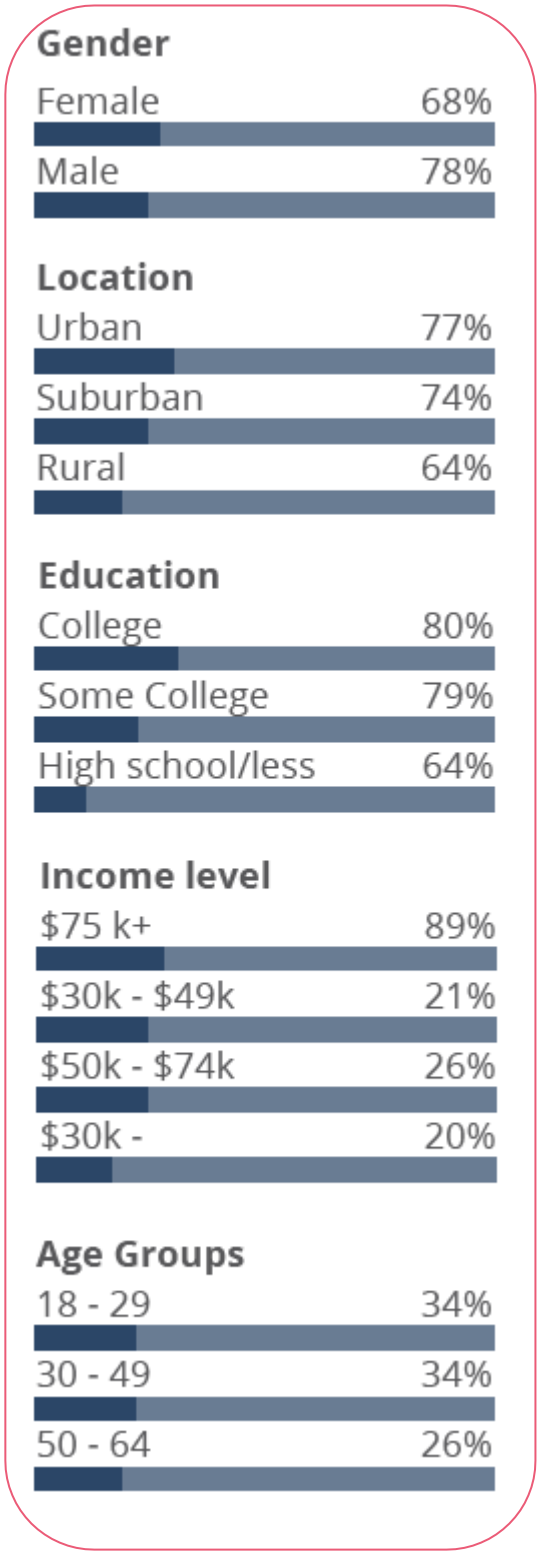
- 310 million monthly active users
- An average of 3.5 billion snaps created every day
- The average time on SnapChat is approximately 25 to 30 minutes
- More than 400 million Snapchat stories are created per day
- 95% of Snapchat users say that app makes them feel happy
- More than 20 000 photos are shared every second
- Countries with the largest Snapchat audiences are US, UK and France
- 57% of brand content on Snapchat is video



Youtube

Facts

- YouTube has 1.9 billion monthly active users
- 79% of internet users say they have a YouTube account
- YouTube supports 80 different languages
- 1 billion hours of video are watched on YouTube every day
- 62% of businesses use YouTube as a marketing channel
- Over 70% of watch time is on mobile
- 90% of people say they discover new brands or products on YouTube
- 500 hours of video is uploaded to YouTube every minute
- YouTube is responsible for 37% of all mobile internet traffic



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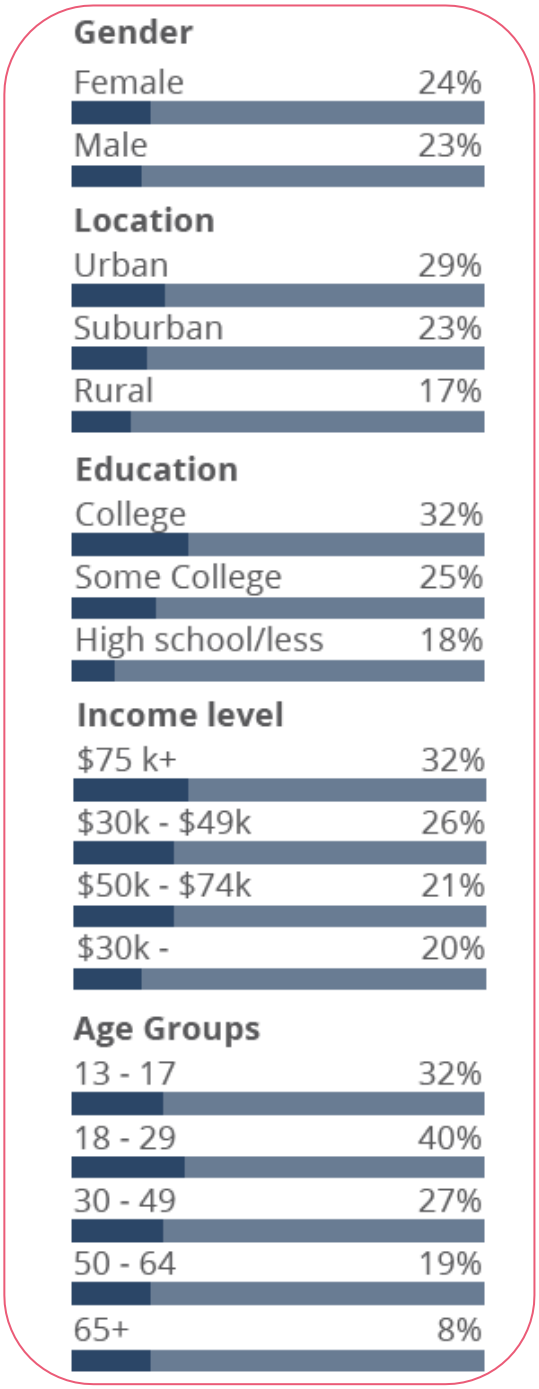


Twitter

Facts

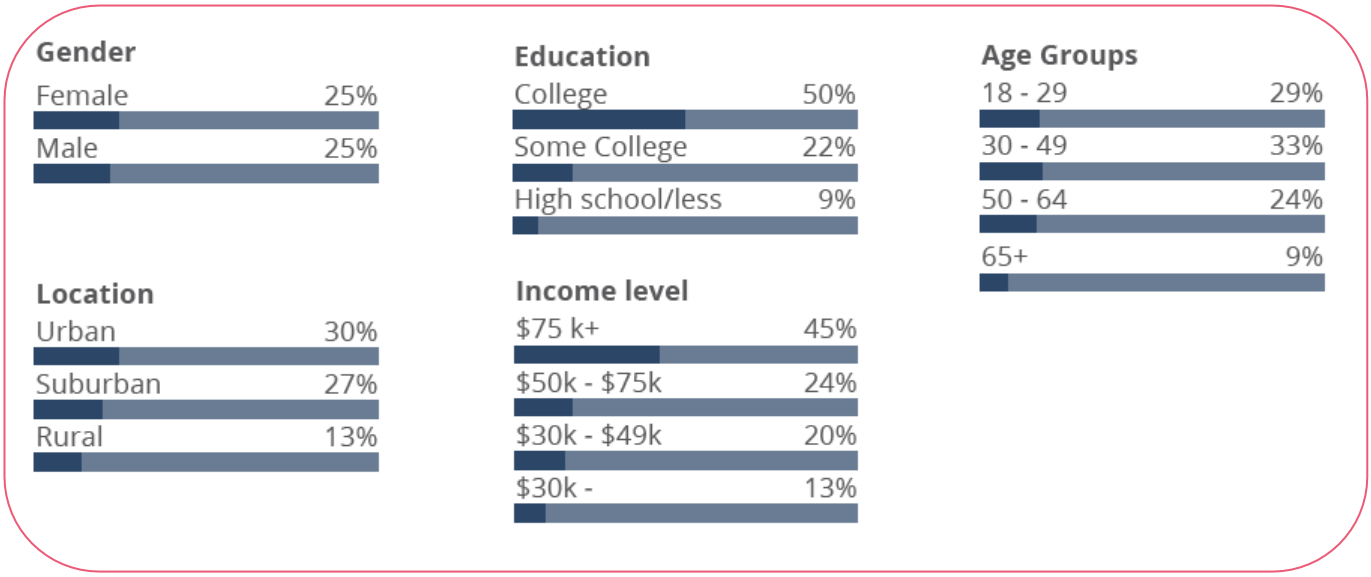
- 336 million monthly active users
- 500 million tweets posted every day
- 23% of the internet population are on Twitter
- The average Twitter user has 707 followers
- 77% of Twitter users feel more positive about a brand when their Tweet has been replied to
- Twitter supports more than 40 languages
- Twitter serves more than 2 billion search queries per day
- 83% of the world's leaders are on Twitter
- 80% of active users access the site on mobile

LinkedIn

Facts

- LinkedIn is responsible for 80% of B2B social media leads
- 77% of recruiters are on LinkedIn
- The average user spends 17 minutes on LinkedIn per month
- Job seekers spend up to 30 minutes per day on LinkedIn
- 33% of millionaires use LinkedIn
- 57% of LinkedIn members use mobile
- 27% of LinkedIn members have between 500 and 999 connections
- LinkedIn is available in 24 languages

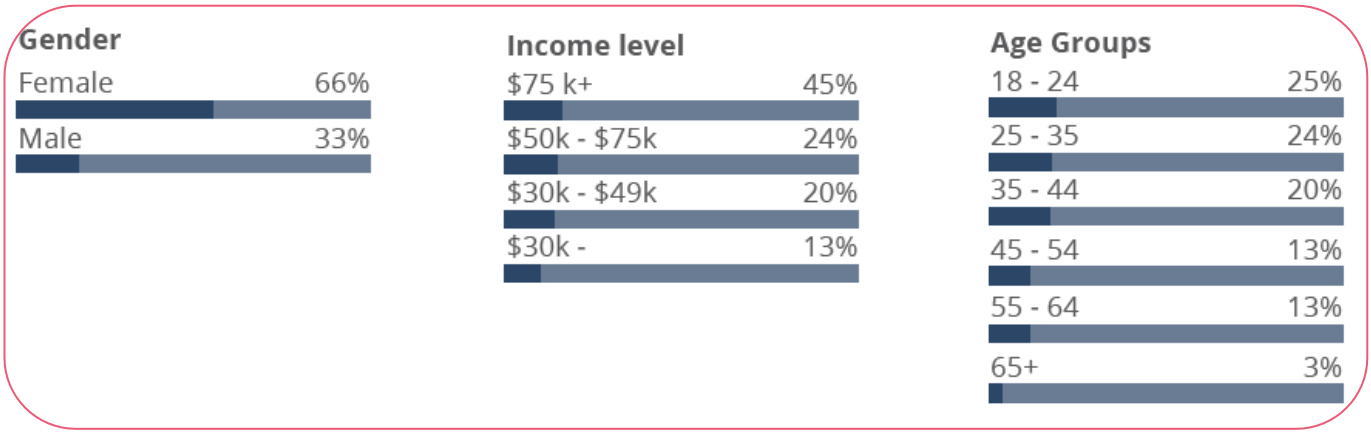
Demographics



TikTok

Facts

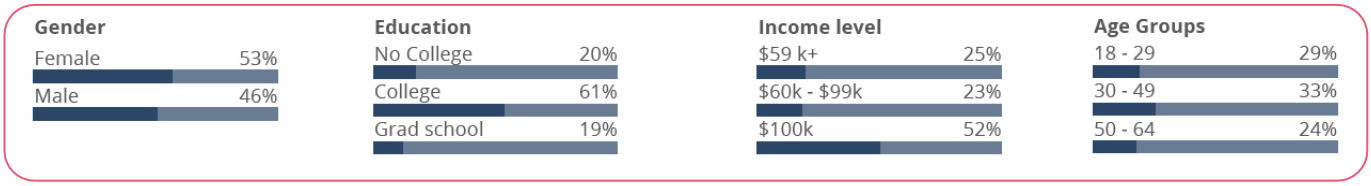
- 500 million TikTok users
- Average user spends 52 minutes on the app
- TikTok is available in 75 languages
- TikTok's user engagement rate is 29%



Yelp

Facts

- 139 million unique visitors
- 67 million reviews to date
- 86 000 active small business accounts
- Shopping/Retail is the largest business category with 23% of reviewed businesses, followed by restaurants at 19% and home local services at 12%.
- After visiting Yelp 93% of visitors make a purchase (exclaimer: provided you have a good review)
- 89% of visitors make a purchase within one week of visiting Yelp.
- Over half of Yelp users take action with a local business - this can be calling, visiting or making a purchase.
- Yelp penetration leads to an increase in revenue for independent companies, while usually leading to a decrease in revenue for chains.
- Yelp is available in 15 languages.
- 79% of the searches were done on mobile



How to choose a Social Media Platform

1. What industry are you in? A law firm is not necessarily going to use Instagram for their social media.
2. Who is your target audience and what platforms are they on?
3. What resources are at your disposal? Remember that you have to ideate and create all the content that you want to post to each platform - do you have the tools, time and man-power to do it?
4. What kind of budget do you have?

General Platform Guidelines for your Business

If you are a start-up look at 1 or 2 platforms maximum. If you are a medium to large company you can look at 2 to 3 platforms. If you are an enterprise you can use about 3 to 6 platforms.

Quick Reference Marketing Terms

Brand Awareness
The extent to which customers are able to recall or recognise a brand.

Community Platforms
An online space where a group of unified individuals are encouraged to interact with each other and hold open discussions about common interests.

Content
Content is the information and experience that are directed towards an end-user or audience.

Demographics
Statistical data relating to the population and particular groups within it.

Engagement
Measurement of public shares, likes and comments.

Impressions
An impression is the number of times your content was displayed.

Interactive Platforms
Platforms that allow for content that requires active engagement from its consumers.

Microblogging
The activity or practice of making short, frequent posts to a microblog.

Photo Sharing
Publishing or transfer of a user's digital photos online.

Resources
An economic or productive factor required to accomplish an activity.

Social Media Platform
Web-based technology that enables the development, deployment and management of social media solutions and services.

Social Networking
The use of dedicated websites and applications to interact with other users, or to find people with similar interests.

Tags
A social media tag allows users to engage with an individual or business profile when mentioned in a post or comment.

Target Audience
The intended audience or readership of a marketing message.

Thought Leader
An individual or firm that is recognised as an authority in a specialised field and whose expertise are sought and often rewarded.

Users
Individuals who make use of a particular social media service.

Video Sharing
A platform that allows users to upload and share their video clips.